



Global Renewable Energy in 2025: How Far Have We Come?

A data-driven overview of renewable energy's growing share in global primary energy and electricity – spotlighting hydropower, wind, and solar.

Source: Our World in Data (Ritchie, Roser, Rosado).



75% of Global GHG Emissions Still Come from Fossil Fuels



Energy systems built on fossil fuels

Since the Industrial Revolution, most countries' energy systems have been dominated by coal, oil, and gas.



~3/4 of global emissions

Three-quarters of global greenhouse gas emissions come from burning fossil fuels for energy.



5M+ dead

Fossil fuel combustion pollution causes 5 million+ premature deaths annually.

Implication: Rapid scale-up of low-carbon electricity is necessary — renewables and nuclear are central options.

Source: Our World in Data — Renewable Energy.

Renewables Now Supply ~14% of Global Primary Energy

Primary energy uses the substitution method (2024).

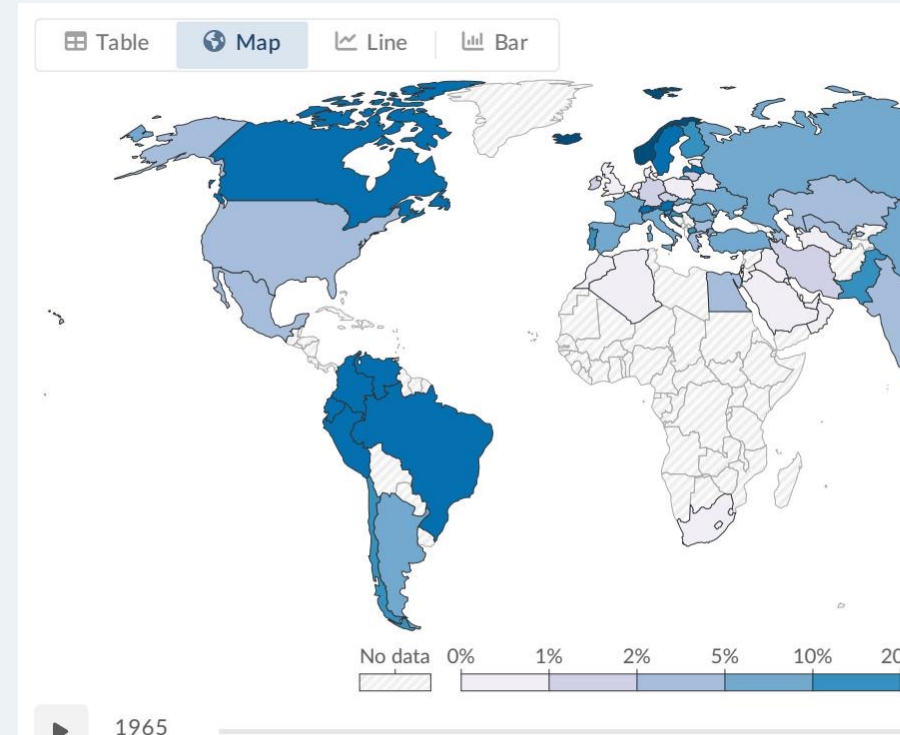
~14%

of global primary energy

Primary energy includes electricity, transport, and heating — sectors where decarbonization is uneven. Transport and heating remain more reliant on oil and gas.

≈ one-seventh of total primary energy

Source: [Our World in Data – Renewable Energy \(2024, substitution method\)](#).



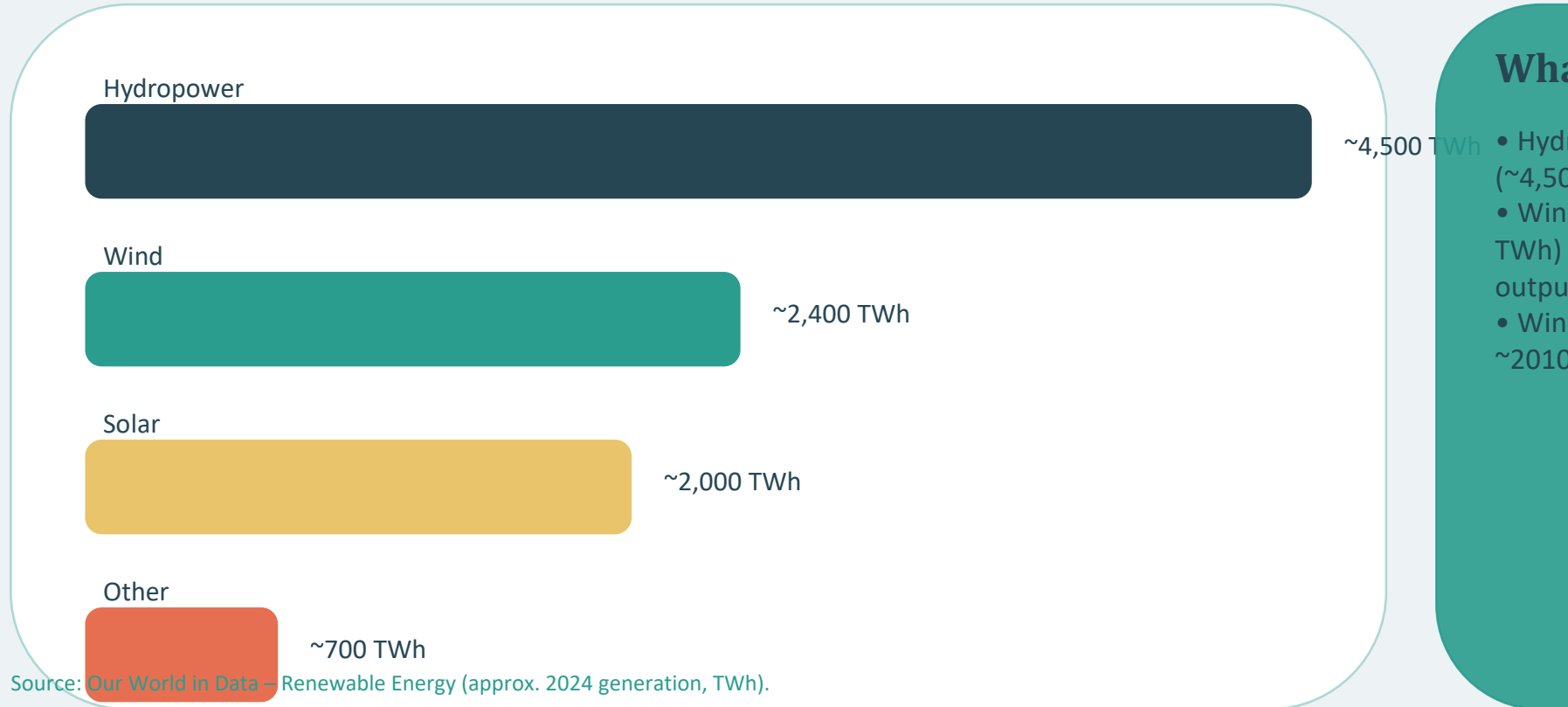
Share of primary energy from renewables by country (2024)

Data source: Energy Institute - Statistical Review of World Energy (2025) - [Learn more about](#)

[OurWorldinData.org/energy](#) | CC BY

Renewable Electricity Generation Is Growing Rapidly, Led by Wind

Approx. global renewable electricity generation by technology (2024).



Almost One-Third of Global Electricity Now Comes from Renewable

Renewable electricity share by country (2025).

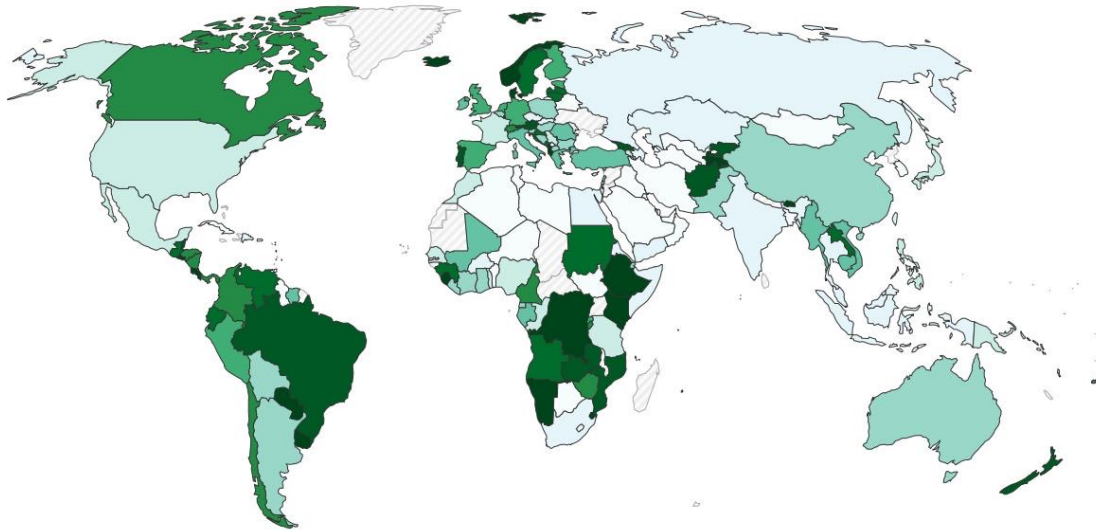
Share of electricity production from renewables, 2025

Renewables include solar, wind, hydropower, bioenergy, geothermal, wave, and tidal sources.

Our World
in Data

Table Map Line Bar

Select countries



Share of electricity from renewables by country (2025)

Source: Our World in Data – Renewable Energy (approx. 2025 shares).

Data source: Ember (2026); Energy Institute - Statistical Review of World Energy (2025) – Learn more about this data

Select

Country

Norway

Brazil

Canada

China

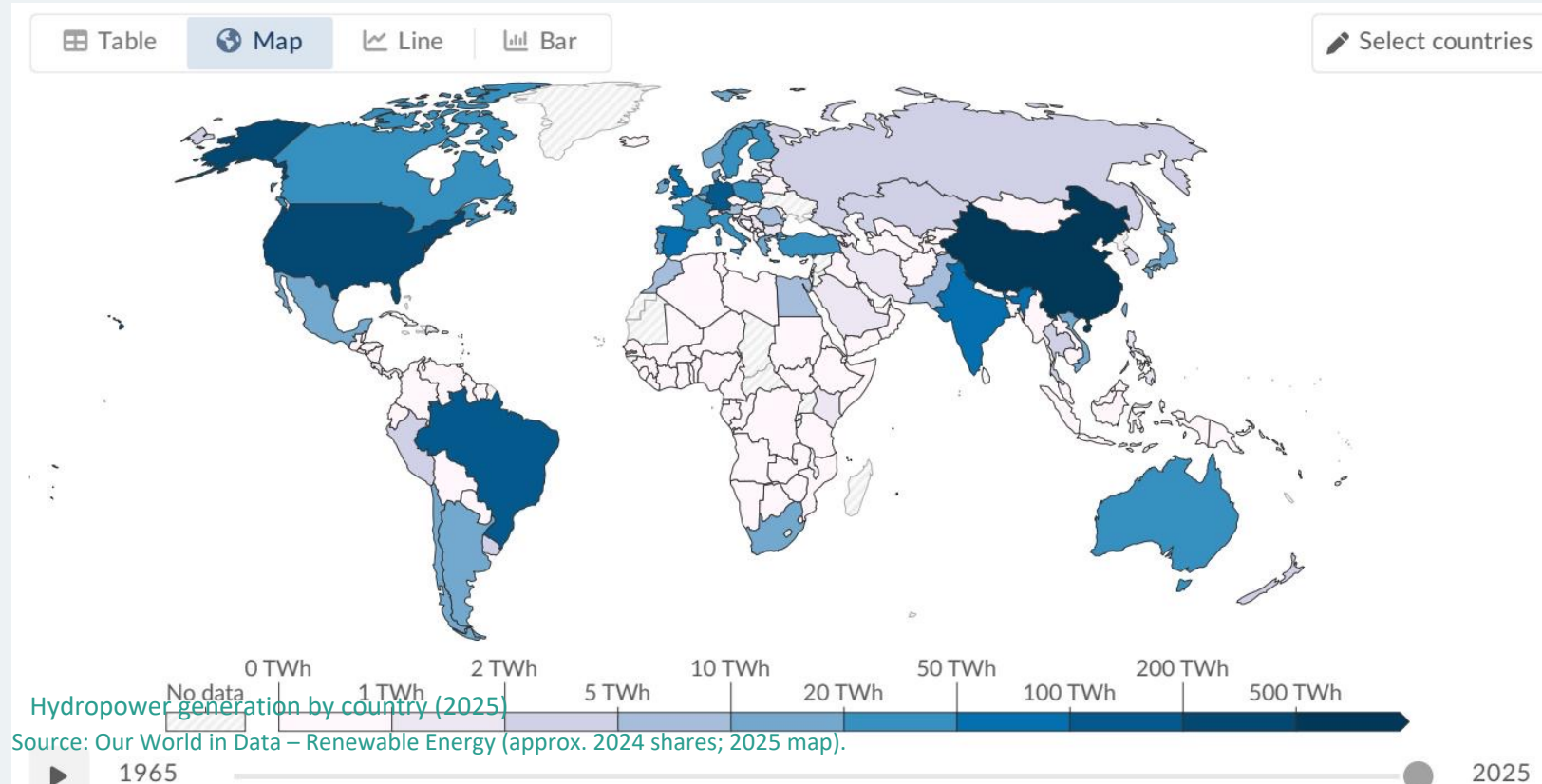
India

Saudi Ar

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Hydropower Remains the Largest Renewable Source at ~50% of Ge

Hydro accounts for roughly half of renewable electricity.

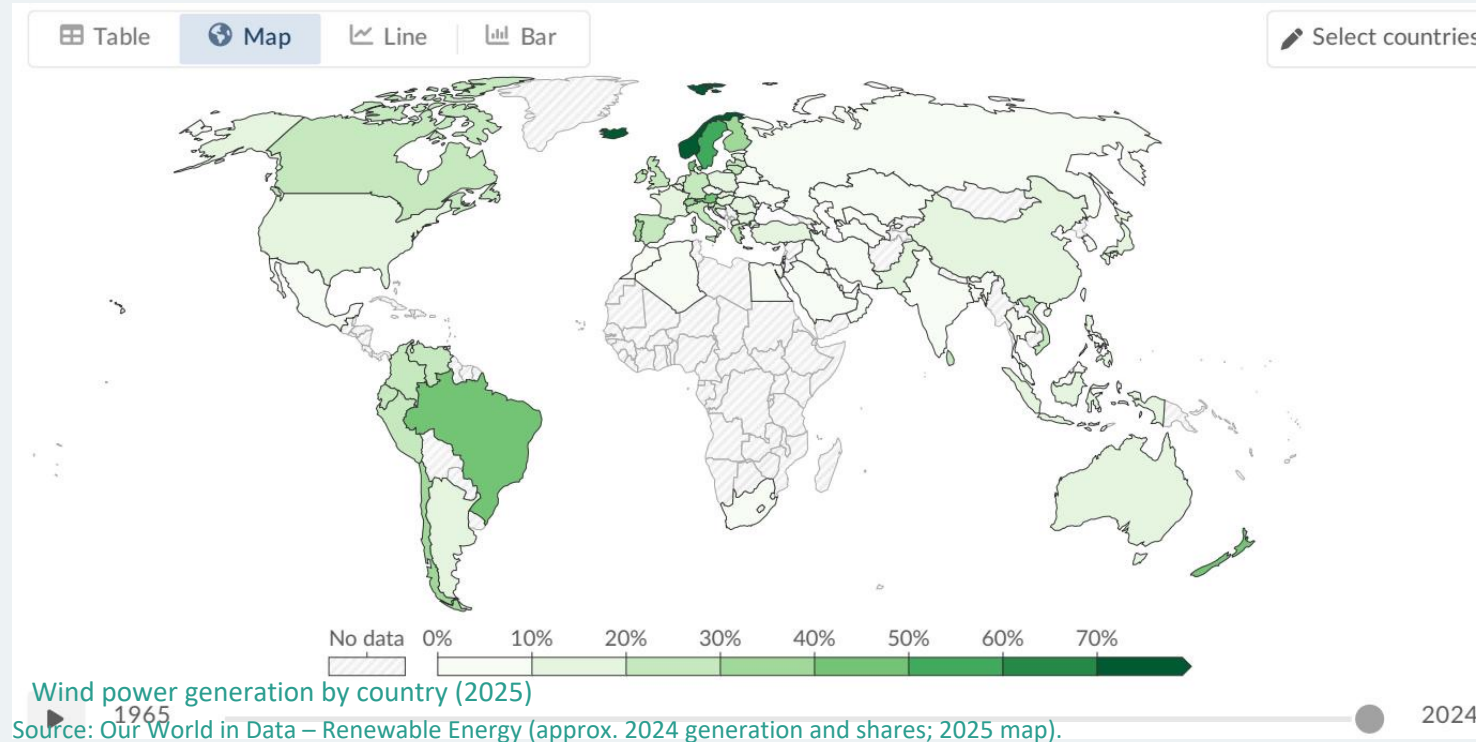


Key

- Largest
- half of
- Long
- large
- Top
- and

Wind and Solar Are the Fastest-Growing Energy Technologies in History

Wind ~2,400 TWh vs solar ~2,000 TWh (2024); both have surged since ~2010.



Wind vs solar

Wind

~2,400 TWh

~25% of renewable energy

Solar

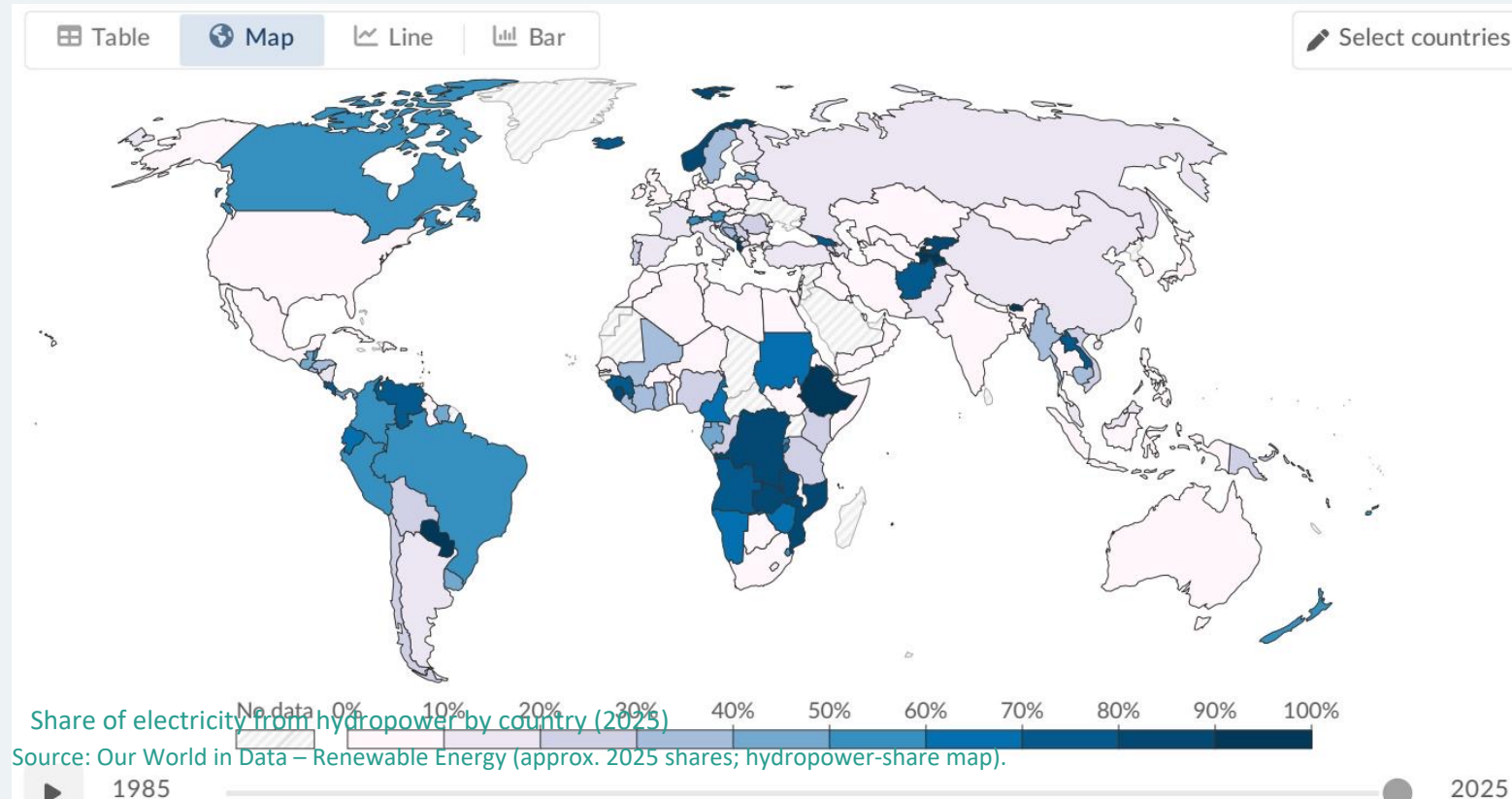
~2,000 TWh

~21% of renewable energy

Together, wind and solar output — and a

Stark Regional Gaps: Sub-Saharan Africa Lags While Scandinavia and Latin America Lead

Uneven transition reflects resource endowments, investment, and policy.



What o

- Abunda
- Canada.
- Targete
- Germany
- Limited
- Africa ha
- build-out
- Persiste
- Eastern s
- fuel base

Example
Norway
Saudi A

Key Takeaways: Renewables Are Growing Fast Transition Must Accelerate

What this means for strategy

- ~14% of global primary energy and ~30% of global electricity are renewable.
- Hydropower is still dominant (roughly half of renewable electricity).
- Wind (~2,400 TWh) and solar (~2,000 TWh) are scaling rapidly and together nearly match hydro output.
- Regional disparities remain: Scandinavia/Latin America lead; parts of the Middle East and Sub-Saharan Africa lag.
- Transport and heating lag behind electricity, keeping overall primary-energy progress slower.

Accelerate

Policy and investment

- Scaling wind + solar
- Modernizing grids
- Expanding clean heat (transport + heating)